

universities have started offering postgraduate degree courses specifically in quality management and testing techniques through distance learning programmes. The Indian Institute of Quality Management (IIQM), Jaipur, under the Standardised, Testing and Quality Certification (STQC) directorate has been conducting a two-year distance-learning postgraduate programme in quality management in collaboration with Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS), Pilani, since 1998. Nearly a thousand candidates have passed out till date from the institute that works under the Department of Information Technology, Government of India, informs A.K. Malik, director, Indian Institute of Quality Management (IIQM). The eligibility criterion is the same as applicable to any other management course, Malik adds.

Who should opt for it

Candidates who wish to pursue quality testing as profession should have a quantitative, analytical aptitude. They should be able to reason mathematical problems, and, at the same time, must be observant to pick a qual-

“**One must have full knowledge of the process and product, as well as quality tools**—Anil Bali, vice president, Deki Electronics

ity related issue and brainstorm over it to find its fix.

However, quality testing is not so simple. People who wish to pursue it also need to be technically sound and equipped with a host of knowledge on test and measurement equipment, failure mode and effects analysis (FMEA), data analysis methods and engineering models.

“Generally, a quality testing professional in an electronics manufacturing company is required to prevent non-conforming raw materials from going to the shop floor, prevent dispatch of non-conforming products to the customers, and develop and implement innovative approaches to improve yields by use of quality tools like Six Sigma (reduction of defects) and DOE (design of experiments). Thus one must have full knowledge of the process and product, as well as quality tools like seven tools of quality control, DOE and Six Sigma, standards and measurement systems. A successful candidate must also have experience of working on standards like ISO 9001:2008 and TS 16949,” says Bali.

Not to forget the soft skills

Quality testing is not restricted to the technical aspects of testing and quality management alone. Over the

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